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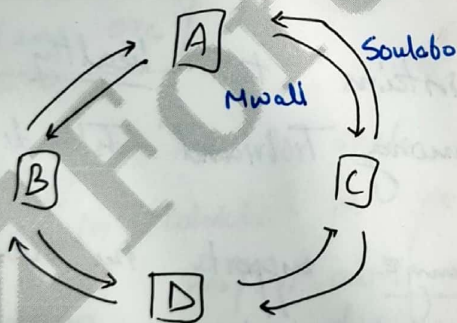
e) Kula Exchange

(10 Marks)

Malinowski in his book, "Argonauts of the Western Pacific" mentioned about the "Kula Exchange" which is practised about Trobriand Islanders of Melanisia."

Kula Exchange

It is the process of exchange of two ornaments "Soulabo" and "Mwali" among the Trobriand Islanders.



A, B, C, D → Islanders

→ Kula exchange is more of a cultural activity rather than an economic activity as the Trobriand Islanders undertake

long and hazardous voyages for the exchange of such ornaments.

→ The exchange of food grains also takes place along with the ornaments but such exchange is secondary.

→ Thus Malinowski mentioned that Kula exchange is necessary to maintain the social relations among Trobriand Islanders and this is not a true economic activity.

→ Kula exchange maintains the healthy social relations among Trobriand Islanders.

→ Thus, Kula exchange supports the substantivist school of thought as propagated by 'Karl Polanyi' in his book, "The Great Transformation".

Feedback

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